



Presenting Your Sprint Review

Why This Matters

- A sprint review isn't a status report, and it isn't a demo for its own sake
- It's the moment your team proves the sprint goal was met and gets feedback before moving on
- First-time agile teams often confuse "we were busy", "we did this", "we learnt that" with "we delivered something"
- This session is about closing that gap



Your 15 Minutes

- Sprint goal and context — 1 to 2 minutes
- The deliverable itself, demo or walkthrough — 5 to 6 minutes
- Key decisions and what was learned — 2 to 3 minutes
- Team and process reflection — 1 minute
- That leaves the 5 minutes of Q&A completely untouched
- Bad practice: spending 7 of your 10 minutes on the ceremonies you ran, then rushing the database in the last 90 seconds





Good Practice vs Bad Practice

Opening the Presentation

- State the sprint goal in one sentence in the first 30 seconds
- Example: “Our goal was a working schema for tracking a trader’s positions and trades”

- Opening with “So, um, this week we did a lot of Agile stuff”
- No stated objective anywhere in the first two minutes



Showing the Deliverable

- A slide of bullet points describing the database instead of showing it
- Saying “it’s all in the repo” and moving on
- An actual live look at the database: schema diagram, a real query running, sample data
- Something the audience can see exists and works



Explaining Your Decisions

- Picking two or three real design decisions and explaining the reasoning
- Why this table structure, why Postgres now and how Snowflake fits later, a normalisation choice the team debated

- Listing every table and column read straight off the schema
- No reasoning attached to any of it



Talking About the Team

- Everyone reading their own paragraph back to back with no connection between them
- Naming who worked on what without turning it into a list of job titles
- Being honest about what didn't get finished, and why



Using the Tools as Evidence

- A quick, real look at something like a merged pull request, a Jenkins build, or a git log
- Proof the workflow was actually used, not just described

- A slide that just lists “Git, Jenkins, VSCode, Postgres” as bullet points
- No evidence any of them were actually touched



Slide Design

- Dense paragraphs of text
- The presenter then reads them aloud word for word

- Few words per slide, one idea per slide
- Diagrams over paragraphs



Delivery

- Facing the audience, not the screen
- A steady pace, with eye contact during the parts that matter most

- Reading directly off notes or slides in a monotone
- Speaking only to the one team member holding the laptop



Handling the Q&A

- One person answering everything
- Arguing that a question isn't fair
- Answering the actual question asked
- Admitting “we didn't get to that yet” when it's true
- Letting different team members field different questions



Traps First-Time Agile Teams Fall Into

- Over-explaining the ceremonies instead of the deliverable
- Apologising repeatedly for an incomplete sprint instead of stating what was learned
- Treating the review as a rehearsed monologue rather than a conversation with the room



Quick Checklist Before You Present

- Goal stated in one sentence
- Deliverable actually shown live
- Two or three decisions explained with reasoning
- Tool evidence included
- Time budget respected
- Everyone on the team speaks



Next: The Sprint Retrospective